

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 9 7 3

♦ K J 6 2

♣ 8 2

♠ 7

♥ A K Q 8 6 2

♦ A 5

♣ Q 9 5 3



♠ 9 8 4

♥ J 5

♦ 10 9 8

♣ A K 10 7 4

♠ A J 6 5 2

♥ 10 4

♦ Q 7 4 3

♣ J 6

You respond with your 5-card Major, 1♠.

Partner jumps to 3♥.

With partner's 16-18 points you probably have enough strength for game.

With partner's six ♥s you have an 8-card fit.

So you bid 4♥.

South would play 4♥.

West

North

East

South

1♥

Pass

1♠

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

Click

North plays 4♥. East leads ♣A, ♣K, ♣4. West plays ♣8 then ♣2.

4♥ by North

North plays 4♥. East leads ♣A, ♣K, ♣4. West plays ♣8 then ♣2.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 3 : Total = 4

Suppose you discard a ♦ from dummy. If West doesn't ruff this ♣10 then your ♣Q will win. You could then try to establish dummy's ♦Q to discard your fourth ♣ on.

But you know that plan won't work because West **IS** going to ruff this ♣ if you discard. You only have one chance to make this contract, and that is the chance that West was not dealt the ♥J. So you ruff with dummy's ♥10 and pray West doesn't over-ruff.

The prayer was answered, West did not hold the ♥J.

So you won that trick and still had your ♣Q to use after you pulled trumps.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 5 2

♥ 9

♦ K Q J 9

♣ Q J 7 5

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 10

♦ A 6 3

♣ A 9 8 4 2



♠ A J 10 8 4

♥ 4 3

♦ 10 7 4

♣ K 10 3

♠ Q 7

♥ K Q 8 7 6 5 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 6

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

must establish the ♣ suit **NOW**.

Win the ♦ A, play ♣ A and ruff the ♣ 2 with a high trump. Play a ♥ to the ♥ 10 and ruff the ♣ 4 with a high trump. Play a ♥ to the ♥ J and ruff the ♣ 8 with a high trump. Play a ♥ to the ♥ A and discard a loser on the good ♣ 9.

It took a 4-3 ♣ split to make this contract.

Fortunately that occurs a high percentage of the time. In any case, there was no other hope.

Responding to preempts is easy. You don't count points, you just count tricks. Assume partner for 6 tricks and add yours to see how high to go (or not go).

Here, with three Aces and a possible ♠ ruff you raise to game.

North would play 4♥.

Click

South plays 4♥. East leads the ♦ K.

Things look grim. The defense has exposed your ♦ losers already and those two ♠ losers seem pretty obvious also. If you are to make this contract you must do so before you lose the lead. That means you

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 4 2
♥ 10 9 5 3
♦ 7 4 2
♣ 5 4 3

♠ J 10 5

♥ K Q 6

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 9

 N
W E
 S

♠ Q 9 7 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 6 5

♣ 8 6 2

♠ K 8 6

♥ A 8 4

♦ A Q 8

♣ Q J 10 7

West

North

East

South

Pass

1NT

Pass

4NT

All Pass

6NT by North

Winner count: ♠ 0 : ♥ 3 : ♦ 4 : ♣ 4 : Total = 11

It's pretty clear which suit you have to worry about! Your goal is simple, you must win one ♠ trick before you lose two. So the crux of your problem is: Who holds the ♠ A and ♠ Q?

If East has both of them you are guaranteed to win the first trick no matter what you play.

If West has both of them you are going to lose the first two tricks no matter what you play.

The problem is to decide what to do if they are split. The answer relies on psychology, not on probability. East has made an attacking lead. But if you were East would you start out leading a low ♠ from a suit like ♠ A 9 7 3? That would be incredibly foolhardy, you would probably lead a different suit and save your ♠ A for catching something high from declarer. On the other hand you would be quite likely to lead a small card from ♠ Q 9 7 3.

Your PLAN should be to play low in dummy and win your ♠ 10 if West withholds the ♠ A.

If you think East has ♠ A 9 7 3 then you should play the ♠ K from dummy. But if you think East has ♠ Q 9 7 3 you should play low from dummy.

Since East is unlikely to underlead an Ace against 6NT you play West for the ♠ A.

You have 16 points - a pretty solid 16 in fact. Partner has 15, 16 or 17, so together you have 31, 32 or 33. You want to invite partner to bid 6NT if he has 17, but to decline if he has 15. The correct bid for this invitation is 4NT. It is called a "quantitative" 4NT since it is just an invitational raise. It is **NOT** Blackwood - if you wanted to ask for Aces you would use Gerber.

Partner bids the slam.

South would play 6NT.

Click

North plays 6NT. East leads the ♠ 3.

North plays 6NT. East leads the ♠ 3.